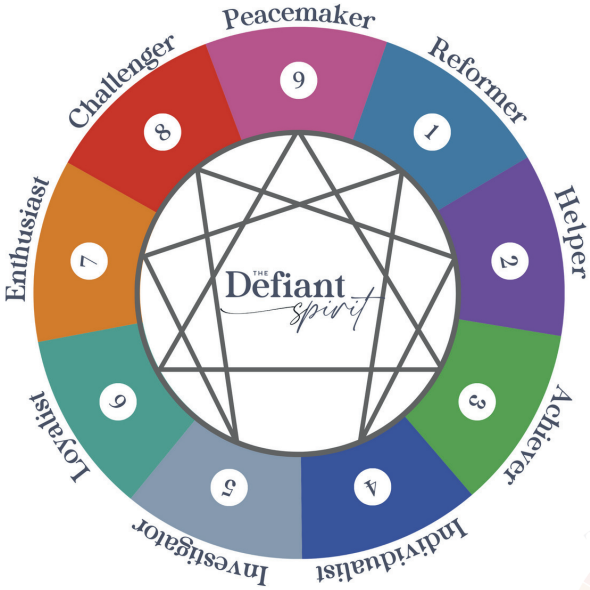
9 Shades of Love

THE ENNEAGRAM OF SEX, LOVE & INTIMACY

"Between stimulus and response, there is a space. In that space lies our freedom and our power to choose our response. In our response lies our growth and our happiness." -Dr.Viktor Frankl

The Enneagram is not new, in fact, it's really old.

It's been around for thousands of years within spiritual traditions, mathematics, geometry, and psychology, and yes, adapted into a personality typing system.



However, unlike other personality typing systems such as Meyers-Briggs (MBTI) or DISC, it's sticky.

Seriously, when was the last time you applied your MBTI type at a cocktail party, used it at a bar, or turned to it to help you navigate the most intimate yet confusing, complex, and downright maddeningly complicated spaces in anyone's life - the bedroom? Yes, the bedroom.

In my work as a therapist, coach, and guide, I am asked over and over again for tools, strategies, and roadmaps to navigate the complexities of life. Nowhere do we need this more than within our intimate relationships, particularly when it comes to sex and what happens when we close that bedroom door?

The Enneagram is that roadmap, and although it is deep, complex, and has so many layers to offer you about how to create true intimacy in your relationships, it's also an amazing quick reference guide showing you how they react - what they fear, and how they respond - what gets them going, get's them off, but most of all, what makes them feel seen.

So use these Enneagram summaries and the "Cheat Sheet" as a jumping-off point, but don't stop there. I have numerous Enneagram resources for you to learn to become a better lover, go deeper in your relationships, and most of all, experience true intimacy: into-me-see, to see your lover and make them feel seen.

May this resource be a roadmap for you on your way to creating true intimacy!

Dr. Baruch "B" HaLevi

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	CORE VALUES	CORE FEAR / IN REACTION	CORE DESIRE / IN RESPONSE
The Reformer 1	• INTEGRITY • ORDER • PERFECTION	Sex can be seen as “dirty,” immoral, or just plain wrong. “Perfection” doesn’t belong in the bedroom which may leave them frustrated.	Help them let go of perfectionism and release their critical nature. Remind them that it's “good” to be “bad” and messy in this one place.
The Helper 2	• CONNECTION • COMPASSION • COMMITTMENT	To be unloved or undesired can cause them have sex for the wrong reasons, go through the motions, or tell you they don’t have needs.	They want to please their lover but are also in touch with their needs. Be sure to see them, tend to them, and give to them, not just receive.
The Achiever 3	• SUCCESS • AMBITION • EFFICIENCY	They fear failure, or leaving you less than impressed. They may fake it, or just go through the motions, but not the emotions.	Help them get away from image or performance, and get back into their heart. Remind them its not about efficiency but intimacy in this space.
The Individualist 4	• FEELING • AUTHENTICITY • EXPRESSION	They fear rejection for being ordinary and unworthy of your love. This brings up a lot of shame and can cause them to "go dark."	They need you to “feel” them and not just feel them up. Unlike the 3s, help them get out of their emotions and into motion and play in the dark.
The Investigator 5	• THINKING • CURIOSITY • INDEPENDENCE	They fear not knowing enough, or having enough energy, especially around relationships, love, and what no one understands - sex.	Give them plenty of prep time for the big date. Keep it simple, go slow, and remember they live in their head so start with fantasy and wind up in bed.
The Loyalist 6	• DUTY • SECURITY • LOYALTY	They fear being unsafe, insecure, or not belonging, which causes them to shut down, but above all else, disloyalty is the dealbreaker.	Help them feel safe and secure, lock the doors, and make them feel they belong. Yes, let them serve you, but be sure you loyally give it right back.
The Enthusiast 7	• FREEDOM • EXPERIENCE • JOY	They fear boredom, being stuck, or missing out on the fun. This can cause to seem absent, be disloyal, or focus on their needs, not yours.	Give them plenty of choices and spices, and throw in a few vices. However, insist they reciprocate on both “presents” and presence.
The Challenger 8	• POWER • TRUTH • CONTROL	They fear being controlled, exposed and above all feeling weak. They may be armored up or disappear beyond reach.	Tell them the truth, be direct, and say what you need. They can give up control as long as you take the reins, pull hard, and even make them scream.
The Peacemaker 9	• PEACE • COMFORT • FLOW	They fear conflict or won’t speak up afraid they won’t be your type. When this happens they’ll shut down or disappear in plain sight.	Encourage them to speak up and say what they like and hate. Support them, honor their choices, and don’t be surprised when they erupt like an 8.